



BEYOND BOUNDARIES

Roy Krishna is a **rare instance** of a foreign player singing the Indian national anthem prior to kick-off in ISL matches.

Nationalities get blurred when the mind gets enamoured by the culture and language of the new address of employment. This is the case of the Fijian striker Roy Krishna, who has developed a great affinity with the land of his ancestors ever since he arrived in India. Krishna is a rare instance of a foreign player singing the Indian national anthem prior to kick-off in the ISL matches.

"When I first landed here, I felt I had been here before. My ancestors left Indian shores 140 years ago but I was surprised to see hundreds of fans waiting to receive me when I came to Kolkata. It revived the mental connect that I always had with this country. The fans were chanting my name, Krishna, the way I like to pronounce it and that made me feel more at home. I always wanted to come back here on a holiday to experience what I saw in the Bollywood movies," said Krishna during a chat with ISL's YouTube programme, *In The Stands*.

"I learnt Hindi in school and it was easy to understand the Indian national anthem. I like the culture and food of this country and my child was also born in Goa in India. I feel greatly connected to this

country," Krishna said, when asked about the reason he joins his Indian teammates in singing 'Jana Gana Mana'.

Having scored 54 goals in the 102 games he has played so far, Krishna, who has made India his second home since arriving to play for ATK in 2019, flourished in his role as a fine striker. After ATK, he also turned out for Mohun Bagan and Bengaluru FC before joining Odisha FC, where he has already scored 12 goals to be in the race for the Golden Boot again.

Amitabha Das Sharma

Story of two different halves

Two years ago Hyderabad FC was on a high, winning its maiden ISL title